

### **8.3 SPIRITUAL, MORAL, ETHICAL, SOCIAL AND CULTURAL ISSUES**

This Specification provides a framework which gives candidates opportunities to extend their understanding of the diverse heritage of music, thus promoting their own spiritual and cultural awareness, understanding and development. This understanding is directed by the specific content of the Areas of Study, e.g. Area of Study 4 (*Traditions and Innovation*) enhances candidates' knowledge of the influence of music on the lives of people around the world, both past and present; it details the role that music plays in establishing and reflecting the changing nature of cultural identity. Area of Study 3 (*Dance Music*) offers opportunities to compare different moral, social and cultural conditions pertaining to specific types of dance. In the appraisals of their own performance and composition, candidates will have to consider the expressive nature of music: in performing the music of others, what the composer's expressive intentions may have been, how these reflect aspects of the spirituality, morality or ethics of the composer, or the social and cultural context of the composer's life and work and how these may be communicated interpretatively.